WAT SÊ JY

JY PRAAT. ONS TIK. · CARLA SE BESIGHEID

One page for Carla, October 2026. Johannes builds and maintains the tool; Carla owns and runs Wat sê jy and keeps all of the profit. Figures are planning estimates at R17.50 per US dollar, not promises. Legal setup is costed at zero because it is being arranged for free.

THE IDEA IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Afrikaans speakers send voice notes and sit in meetings all day, and nothing turns that speech into good Afrikaans text. WhatsApp's own transcripts skip Afrikaans. The big tools get a third to two thirds of Afrikaans words wrong. Wat sê jy runs on the customer's own computer, uses a model tuned for Afrikaans, and gives back a transcript with speakers labelled that can be corrected line by line. Nothing leaves the machine, which is exactly what lawyers, doctors, churches and schools need. The working version already exists and runs on a Mac today.

WHAT CARLA RUNS

The data, which is the moat. The models are public; anyone can download them. What nobody has is a few hours of real, consented, carefully corrected Afrikaans as people actually speak it. Five minutes of that teaches a model as much as fifty hours of the wrong kind. Building that collection is the first job and the most valuable thing in the business.

The customers. Finding the first churches, practices and schools, onboarding them, answering questions, and collecting payment.

The product's voice. Afrikaans wording, the help text, the website, the social accounts.

Johannes handles the code, the model, the app releases and the technical setup.

THE FIRST SIX MONTHS

WHEN	WHAT CARLA DOES	TIME
Month 1	Record 2–5 hours of real meetings and voice notes, get consent forms signed, correct the drafts in the editor	60–100 hours
Months 2–3	Beta with two or three groups (a church council, a school body, a practice); keep correcting; collect feedback	8–10 hours a week
Months 4–6	First paying customers; 20–50 hours of training audio done; website and pricing live	10–15 hours a week

WHAT IT COSTS TO LAUNCH

ITEM	ESTIMATE
Legal setup (company, Information Officer, privacy notice, consent review)	R0
GPU time for benchmarking and one fine-tune	R2,000–R5,000
Apple and Windows signing so the app installs cleanly	R5,000–R10,000
Domain, hosting, storage	R3,000 a year
Marketing to the first communities	R10,000–R20,000
Total cash to launch	**about R20,000–R40,000**

After launch, running costs are R5,000 to R15,000 a month at small scale. Transcribing an hour of audio on the customer's machine costs nothing, so margins on every paid plan are above 90%.

WHERE THE MONEY COMES FROM

CUSTOMER	PRICE	WHY THEY PAY
Churches: sermons, council minutes	R250–R500 a month	Weekly content, tight community, word of mouth
Legal and accounting practices	R500–R1,500 a seat a month	Client meetings and dictation; audio never leaves the office
Medical practices in the Cape	R1,000+ a seat a month	Afrikaans patients, privacy-safe notes
Municipalities, schools, school bodies	Per seat or per hour	Minutes and records in Afrikaans
Individuals: voice notes, meetings	R90–R180 a month	Convenience; mostly a free tier that spreads the name
Later: licensing the model and data	Deal by deal	The only Afrikaans model tuned on real conversation

CARLA'S PROFIT, TWELVE MONTHS AFTER LAUNCH

	CONSERVATIVE	BASE	UPSIDE
Paying individuals at R120 a month	50	300	1,000
Churches at R350 a month	5	25	80
Professional seats at R700 a month	6	30	120
Enterprise or licensing deals	0	0	2 at R15,000 a month
Annual revenue	≈ R140,000	≈ R790,000	≈ R3.1 million
Annual running cost	R60,000	R180,000	R720,000
Carla's profit	**≈ R80,000**	**≈ R610,000**	**≈ R2.4 million**
Launch cash paid back in	about 5 months	about 1 month	weeks

The conservative case is a solid side income for part-time hours. The base case is a full salary from a business she owns. The upside case is a small company with a part-time helper. Beyond the profit, the corrected dataset and the tuned model are an asset in their own right: this kind of Afrikaans speech data exists nowhere else, and a buyer would pay for it even if the app never grew.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Meta could add Afrikaans to WhatsApp's own transcripts and take away the voice-note hook, though not the meeting and professional business where most of the money sits. South Africans are slow to pay for software, so churches and practices carry the plan, not individuals. Free models keep improving, which is why the corrected data and the customer relationships, not the engine, keep the lead.

FOUR CHECKPOINTS

1. **Month 2:** the model gets under 20% of words wrong on our own recordings.
2. **Month 4:** fifty people using it weekly across two or three groups.
3. **Month 8:** ten paying churches or practices. Register the company in Carla's name at this point.
4. **Month 12:** base case in sight, or keep it as a free tool and a data asset.

KORT OPSOMMING IN AFRIKAANS

Wat sê jy maak Afrikaanse stemboodskappe en vergaderings teks, op die kliënt se eie rekenaar, met 'n model wat vir Afrikaans afgerig is. Die program werk reeds. Johannes bou en onderhou dit; Carla besit en bestuur die besigheid en hou al die wins. Haar werk is die data (egte opnames met toestemming, reël vir reël reggemaak), die kliënte (kerke, praktyke, skole) en die Afrikaanse stem van die produk. Die begin kos sowat R20,000 tot R40,000 kontant, regskoste gratis. Twaalf maande ná bekendstelling: sowat R80,000 wins in die versigtige geval, R610,000 in die basisgeval, R2.4 miljoen in die beste geval, alles hare.